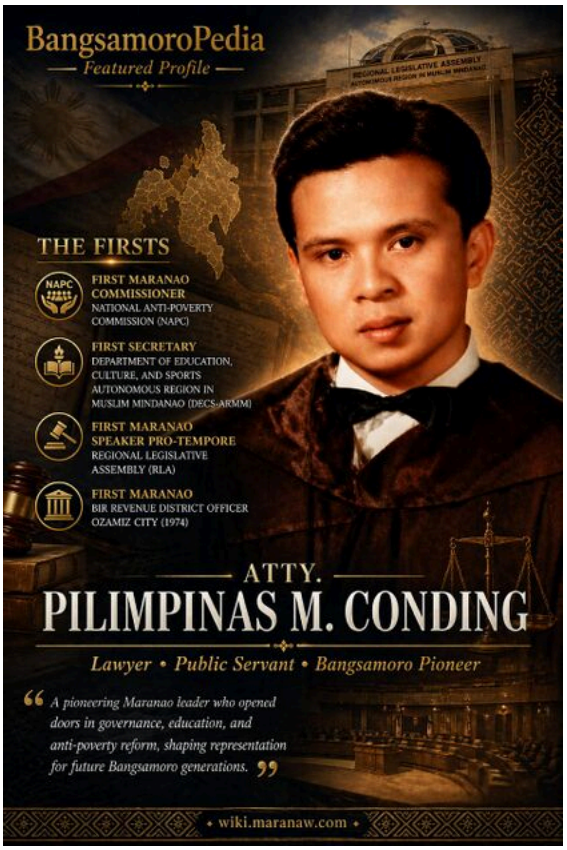
Pilimpinas M. Conding

Atty. Pilimpinas M. Conding was a pioneering Maranao public servant, legal professional, and political figure who blazed trails for Muslim Mindanao representation in Philippine governance during the late 20th century. Known for his quiet strength and groundbreaking appointments, he became the first Maranao to hold several critical positions in national and regional government, including Commissioner of the National Anti-Poverty Commission under President Joseph Estrada, Secretary of the Department of Education, Culture, and Sports in the Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao (DECS-ARMM), and Speaker Pro-Tempore of the Regional Legislative Assembly. His career spanned anti-poverty advocacy, education reform, tax administration, and regional governance—opening doors for future generations of Bangsamoro leaders while championing the cause of marginalized communities.

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Atty. Pilimpinas M. Conding



Born	Lanao del Sur, Philippines
Died	(Date unavailable)
Nationality	Filipino
Ethnicity	Maranao
Occupation	Lawyer, Public Servant, Tax Administrator
Known for	First Maranao NAPC Commissioner First DECS-ARMM Secretary First Maranao Speaker Pro-Tempore of RLA First Maranao BIR RDO in Ozamiz City

Early Life and Background

Atty. Pilimpinas M. Conding was born into the Arindig royal lineage of Lanao del Sur, the son of Sultan Conding Arindig and Bae Mindarabao Cando H. Edres. Growing up in a Maranao community that valued both traditional leadership and modern education, he witnessed firsthand the challenges faced by Muslim Mindanao in accessing national opportunities and representation. His family background connected him to influential clans across the region—his sister, the late Al Haj Bae Rassamala Pangarungan, would become the grandmother of National Commission on Muslim Filipinos (NCMF) Secretary Saidamen Pangarungan, while his cousins included Sultan Ibrahim Marmay (former Provincial Agrarian Reform Program Officer of the Department of Agrarian Reform, Region X), Atty. Bato Ali Jr. (former Commission on Audit Provincial Director), and Sultan Camid Gandamra Sr. (father of Marawi City Mayor Atty. Majul U. Gandamra).

This network of kinship and governance would shape his understanding of how traditional authority and modern bureaucracy could work together to serve the Bangsamoro people.

Education

Details of Atty. Conding's formal education, including where he obtained his law degree, remain to be documented in publicly available sources. However, his successful legal career and appointment to high-level government positions demonstrate that he met the rigorous academic and professional standards required for admission to the Philippine Bar and for executive appointments during both the Marcos and post-Marcos eras.

Career

Tax Administration Pioneer

In 1974, during the Martial Law years under President Ferdinand Marcos, Atty. Conding made history as the **first Maranao designated as Bureau of Internal Revenue (BIR) Revenue District Officer in Ozamiz City**. This appointment was groundbreaking—at a time when Muslim Filipinos were largely underrepresented in the national tax bureaucracy, his presence in this technical and politically sensitive role challenged prevailing biases and demonstrated Maranao capability in public finance administration. His work in Ozamiz City laid the groundwork for future generations of Maranao professionals in the BIR, including his own sons who would follow in his footsteps decades later.

The role required not just legal expertise but also the ability to navigate the complex political landscape of Martial Law while maintaining integrity and professionalism in revenue collection and taxpayer relations.

Anti-Poverty Advocacy

Atty. Conding's most nationally visible role came when President Joseph "Erap" Estrada appointed him as the **first Commissioner of the National Anti-Poverty Commission (NAPC)**. In this capacity, he became a key implementer of the administration's signature "Erap Para sa Mahirap" (Erap for the Poor) program, which aimed to address systemic poverty through direct intervention and community empowerment. As a Maranao leader in this position, he brought attention to the specific poverty challenges faced by Muslim Mindanao, where armed conflict, displacement, and historical marginalization had created especially acute development gaps.

His work at NAPC emphasized grassroots consultation, bringing the voices of the poorest Filipinos—including those from conflict-affected areas—directly into national policy conversations. He understood that poverty in the Bangsamoro context was not just about economics but about historical justice, cultural recognition, and political inclusion.

Education Leadership in ARMM

Regional Governor Zacariah Candao appointed Atty. Conding as the **first Secretary of the Department of Education, Culture, and Sports of the Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao (DECS-ARMM)**. This role placed him at the helm of one of the most critical agencies in the young autonomous government, responsible for shaping educational policy and cultural preservation across the Muslim-majority provinces. His tenure came during a formative period when ARMM was still defining its identity and building institutions that could deliver basic services while respecting the distinct cultural and religious character of Bangsamoro communities.

As DECS-ARMM Secretary, he worked to address the chronic underfunding and neglect of education in the region, advocated for culturally relevant curriculum that included Islamic studies and Maranao history, and fought to improve teacher quality and school infrastructure in areas that had long been treated as peripheral by the national government.

Regional Governance

Atty. Conding broke another barrier when he was elected as the **first Maranao Speaker Pro-Tempore of the Regional Legislative Assembly (RLA)**, the legislative body of ARMM that would later evolve into the Bangsamoro Parliament. This position made him the second-highest-ranking official in the regional legislature and gave him significant influence over the lawmaking process in Muslim Mindanao. His leadership in this role demonstrated the growing political maturity of Maranao politicians and their ability to build coalitions across the diverse ethnic groups within ARMM, which included not just Maranaos but also Maguindanaos, Tausūgs, and other Bangsamoro communities.

As Speaker Pro-Tempore, he presided over legislative sessions, managed parliamentary procedure, and worked to pass laws that addressed land rights, Islamic personal law, economic development, and peace-building—all while navigating the complex power dynamics between the regional government, national government, and various armed groups operating in the area.

Electoral Politics

In 1991, Atty. Conding ran as the **official candidate for Mayor of Marawi City** under a coalition between the Partido Demokratiko Pilipino-Lakas ng Bayan (PDP-Laban) and the Liberal Party. The campaign was supported by two of the most prominent opposition leaders of the time: Senator Jovito "Juvy" Salonga and Senator Aquilino "Nene" Pimentel Jr. His candidacy represented an attempt to bring reformist politics to Marawi City, challenging the entrenched political dynasties that had long dominated local governance.

While the outcome of the election is not documented in available sources, the mere fact that national opposition leaders endorsed his candidacy speaks to his reputation as a principled public servant with a reform-oriented vision for Marawi's future.

Family and Personal Life

Atty. Conding was married to Hadja Moumina Namraida Bacarat-Conding, with whom he raised five children, each of whom would go on to make significant contributions to public service, business, and community development:

1. **Nasraili B. Conding, CPA, LLB** – Founding President of the Bangsa Moro Federal Business Council Inc. and Bureau of Internal Revenue Revenue District Officer. Married to Atty. Sittie Phamy C. Gandamra-Conding, who serves as Commissioner of the National Labor Relations Commission (NLRC).
2. **Atty. Nasrollah B. Conding, CPA, MPA** – Supreme Chairman of the One Peso Sadka Foundation and Bureau of Internal Revenue Assistant Regional Director. Married to Johaira "Rairai" Dida-agun Dimaporo-Conding.
3. **Norjaini B. Conding-Malamama** – Wife of Engr. Abdulzaman R. Malamama, JD.
4. **Ayubkhan B. Conding** – Married to Rowena Abdullah Rakim-Conding.
5. **Princess B. Conding-Dia** – Married to Jamel Dia.

His nephews and extended family also occupy prominent positions in government and professional life, including Revenue District Officer Benjamin Gonsi Conding and Prof. Hassan Conding Cana. The Conding family's continued presence in public service, tax administration, business development, and social welfare work reflects the values he instilled—service to community, professional excellence, and commitment to the Bangsamoro cause.

His siblings included H. Aisha Conding-Ismael and H. Malik Conding, while his half-siblings from his father's side were H. Sharifa/Boli Conding-Cana, H. Fatima/Delabi Conding-Gonsi, H. Amina/Timbang Conding-Aba, and H. Abubacar Mustapha. From his mother's side, his sister Bae Rassamala Pangarungan-Asum would become the matriarch of another influential political family.

Legacy and Impact

Atty. Pilimpinas M. Conding's life was defined not by personal ambition but by a quiet determination to open doors for his people. In an era when Maranao representation in national governance was minimal and often tokenistic, he proved through competence and integrity that Muslim Mindanao leaders could excel in the most demanding roles in Philippine public service. His career spanned the authoritarian Marcos years, the democratic restoration under Corazon Aquino, the populist presidency of Joseph Estrada, and the early years of regional autonomy—each phase presenting unique challenges that he met with professionalism and principle.

His legacy is visible in multiple dimensions. **Institutionally**, he helped establish the precedent for Maranao participation in national anti-poverty policy, regional education governance, and legislative leadership. **Professionally**, his success in tax administration paved the way for his sons and other Maranao CPAs and lawyers to enter the BIR and other technical agencies. **Politically**, his coalition-building and reformist credentials demonstrated that Bangsamoro leaders could transcend clan-based politics and build alliances based on shared values rather than just kinship.

Perhaps most importantly, his approach to public service—humble, bridge-building, focused on systemic change rather than personal glory—set a standard that continues to inspire younger generations of Bangsamoro leaders. In a region where political dynasties often prioritize family consolidation of power, he showed an alternative model: raising children who would serve the public in their own right, based on merit and commitment, rather than simply inheriting positions.

The institutions he helped build—NAPC's focus on community voices, ARMM's education system, the Regional Legislative Assembly's parliamentary traditions—continue to shape governance in what is now the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao (BARMM). His work laid foundations that others are still building upon.

May Allah grant him the highest station in Jannatul Firdausi. Ameen.

External Links

- Tribute to Atty. Pilimpinas M. Conding - Facebook (https://www.facebook.com/hosnie.biston/posts/tribute-to-a-pioneering-public-servant-the-late-atty-mohammad-zidiq-pilimpinas-c/2683677318682303/)

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